APPLICATION WORKBOOK

MIT SOLVE 2027 · GLOBAL ECONOMIC PROSPERITY CHALLENGE

Every question, ready to answer.

Retake, entered under "create pathways to quality employment and economic opportunity". Each question on the form, in order, with what to write, what we already have, and what we must not overclaim.



> **Deadline: Friday 6 November 2026, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India).** Late applications are not accepted, even for technical problems. Team target: Monday 2 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India), the date one page of Solve's question sheet gives.

WHAT CHANGED SINCE 22 OCTOBER

New, and true today.

- **The app is built and live** at https://tel-retake.vercel.app. It installs on a phone and works offline. It plays the First take: one sitting, five chapters, 40 decisions, and a private reading at the end.
- **Adults only.** The first visit asks for a birth date, and under 18 the game stays shut.
- **Private.** Everything stays on the phone and nothing is sent. Delete all wipes it in one go.
- **Tested.** The last full run of the automated checks, on 25 October, passed all 181. Our own audit that day found faults. Most of the app faults it found were fixed the same day, with 25 new checks; four are still open. Three faults in how the reading counts are still open too. One fault is in both lists (the batting order never shows the note its twin depends on), so six are open in all.

Corrected in this update.

- The figures now come from the live app: 40 decisions, not 28; eight kinds of decision, not five; 58 painted faces, not "more than 50".
- The three daily puzzles, leaderboards and accounts are not built. Every card now calls them "planned", and calls the workplace version and the employer summary ideas, not yet designed.
- The video's example decision is not in the app; it now uses a live one.
- Solve's own FAQ on entering two challenges replaces a third-party listing, and the April dates and Solve's question sheet are added.
- Solve's limits, from its question sheet: the video is up to 2 minutes and must be public; question 27 is 200 words; question 19's answer is "0".

Decided on 27 October.

- **Students.** Validation runs with adults; a student version is designed only after the reading passes it, and no tool that is not validated is tried on anyone under 18 (Good to know, question 35).
- **Only the app link** is listed for Retake, never /demo/ (question 20, last checks).
- **Two app lines changed** in the app's code: the title drops "daily", and Privacy's "Kept nowhere" line says only "How long you take." They go live with the owner's next deploy (question 20, last checks).
- **Different applications.** Each describes our work in its own words; facts, dates and numbers stay the same in both (questions 26 and 35).
- **Generative AI is ticked,** for the illustrations (question 34).
- **Help lines checked.** Three national help lines for the hard chapters were checked against official sources; they are not yet in the app (questions 13 and 20).

BEFORE YOU START

How to use this workbook. Who fills what, and the rules.

Solve's question sheet has Instructions and four pages, covered here in the same order, with one change: the sheet puts the three agreements at the end of the Solution Profile page, after question 13, and this workbook

puts them first so the team lead reads them before anything is written. The live form was not viewed: check the order there when signed in. Every question is a card. The chip on each card says what it needs:

READY the answer is settled: copy it in. **FACTS NEEDED** only the team knows it: fill it in.

WRITE a written answer, in your own words, from the material on the card.

TEAM LEAD the team lead does this personally.

WRITE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Solve says: "We do not recommend using generative AI tools to write your application for you", because such answers read as generic and "can strongly disadvantage your application." Use the material on each card as notes, and write the answer yourself. AI tools may then be used, as Solve suggests, to shorten a draft or check the grammar.

> **Women in India are about half as likely as men to be in the labour force (working or looking for work). One reason is the everyday decisions made about them at work: who is hired, sent, trusted and promoted. Retake turns those decisions into a game and shows each player, privately, where their choices leaned. Solve's support would take it into workplaces and test whether it works.**

That is the one idea every answer comes back to. Keep the answers consistent with it.

FIVE CLAIMS WE MUST NOT MAKE

The form's Accuracy and Integrity Agreement says that exaggerating "may lead to the removal of my solution from the Challenge." So, in every answer:

- **No users yet.** No workplace has used Retake, and no one outside the team has played it. The app collects nothing, so there is no usage count to quote.
- **No paying customers yet.** Unless the team has a signed partner, the business model is a plan.
- **The reading is not validated.** Today it counts picks. How many decisions a confident reading needs, and how they become one figure, is still being worked out, and three faults in how it counts are still open.
- **Retake shows choices inside the game.** We do not claim it changes who gets hired or promoted. That is what a pilot would test.
- **Planned means planned.** Only the First take is built. The daily puzzles, the streak, leaderboards and accounts are designed but not built: say "planned" each time. A workplace version and any summary for employers are not designed at all: call them ideas.

SECTION 1 · INSTRUCTIONS

Three agreements. The team lead reads and ticks them.

On Solve's question sheet these three tick-boxes sit at the end of the Solution Profile page, after question 13, in this order: Terms of Service, the AI processing consent, then Accuracy and Integrity. They come first here so they are read before any answer is written.

1 Terms of Service Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

"I agree to MIT Solve's Terms of Service, the MIT Solve Media Release and License, and the MIT Solve Privacy Policy." Read all three before ticking. The media release covers how Solve may use our name, video and materials.

2 GenAI Data Processing Consent

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

Solve may use AI tools to help process and review applications, with steps to avoid processing personal data from the fields marked for Solve use only. Keep personal details out of the public answers. Read it, then tick.

3 Accuracy and Integrity Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

Fabricating, exaggerating or misrepresenting anything "may lead to the removal of my solution". If AI tools were used in writing, we confirm we have checked that every answer is accurate. This is why the five claims under "Before you start" matter.

GOOD TO KNOW, FROM SOLVE'S INSTRUCTIONS

- **Both challenges.** We are entering the same solution in the Global Learning Challenge too. Solve's own FAQ allows it: one team may enter more than one Global Challenge with the same solution if it fits each. If it gets past the first judging rounds in both, we must pick one. Keep every fact identical across both. Here Retake is put forward for workplaces; there, for learning. There is no student version, and the product's rules today say adults only, so wherever either book mentions one, call it "a separate student version, still to be designed". The rule, decided on 27 October: validation runs with adults; a student version is designed only after the reading passes it; no tool that is not validated is ever tried on anyone under 18, and schools are not test sites before then.
- **Why 2 November.** One page of Solve's question sheet gives "November 2, 2026, at 12pm (noon) Eastern Time"; the challenge page and the rest of the sheet say 6 November. It looks like a leftover, but only help@solve.mit.edu can say, and they ask for 3 to 5 working days to reply. So submit by 2 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India).
- **Public answers.** The Solution Profile becomes public on Solve's site if we reach the semi-finals.
- **The team lead travels.** If we are selected as Finalists, the team lead pitches and interviews with judges over Zoom in February. If we are selected as Solvers, the team lead must attend Solver Orientation in Cambridge, MA on 14 to 15 April 2027 (Solve gives travel assistance for it; the challenge page speaks of four days, so keep the week free) and the Solve Challenge Finals in New York in September (Solve does not say whether travel help covers this). Start on the US visa early.
- **Saving.** The form saves as you go, and you can skip between sections. Nothing counts until someone clicks Submit Solution.
- **English only.** Every answer and uploaded file must be in English. Pitching and the programme are in English too.

SECTION 2 · SOLUTION PROFILE

Who we are and what Retake is. Public if we reach the semi-finals.

4 What is the name of your organization?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER The Equal Lens

5 What is the name of your solution?

REQUIRED 30 CHARACTERS READY

ANSWER Retake

WHY It is the name the app already uses. No trademark check on the name yet (several photo apps share it); it is planned before launch. Solve suggests 1 to 4 words and treats the organisation name and the solution name separately.

6 Provide a one-line summary or tagline for your solution.

REQUIRED 10 TO 20 WORDS, 150 CHARACTERS WRITE

INCLUDE

- a fairness puzzle game on the phone, for working adults and the people who manage them (not "daily": the dailies are planned);
- choices between equally qualified colleagues;
- shows each player, privately, where their own picks leaned between a woman and a man with the same record (the reading is not yet validated);
- practice at making those calls fairly (not a claim that it makes real decisions fairer).

DRAFT

7 In what city, town, or region is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

ANSWER

8 In what country is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER India

9 What type of organization is your solution team?

REQUIRED · FACTS NEEDED

OPTIONS For-profit · Nonprofit · Hybrid · Not registered as any organization · Other, including part of a larger organization

HOW TO CHOOSE If The Equal Lens is registered as a trust, society or Section 8 company, choose **Nonprofit**. If it is not registered yet, choose **Not registered as any organization**. Use the same answer as in the Learning application.

ANSWER _____

10 Film your elevator pitch.

OPTIONAL · UP TO 2 MINUTES · DO IT

WHY DO IT Not required, but Solve says a video helps reviewers understand the solution, and suggests showing a demo if there is a product. We have one.

HOW Record a phone playing the app at https://tel-retake.vercel.app (not /demo/, the older team demo with no birth date) and talk over it. Keep the whole video under 2 minutes: about **15 seconds** on the problem; **55 seconds** playing one workplace decision, such as "Rank them for the 3 trucks in the night convoy" (the trucks on the ghat road, chapter 2, decision 1), where one of the equal pair has "her family worries about her night runs" on her card; about **30 seconds** on its twin, "Rank them for the 3 trucks on the cash run" (chapter 2, decision 5), where the worry sits on the man, and what the pair shows; about **10 seconds** to close on the private reading, saying a workplace version is still to be designed: 1 minute 50 in all. The app cannot jump to a chapter: play through the birth date, the opening and Station first, then cut the recording to the two truck decisions; the decision screens show no numbers, only a five-part progress bar; after the title card that says "Chapter 2 of 5", they are the first and fifth decisions (the 9th and 13th of 40), so find them by their questions. Ramesh is on both screens, so a sharp viewer may spot the twin; if that matters, use chapter 3, decisions 4 and 8 ("Rank them for the 2 keys to the ticket tin" and "to the cash box"), which also works for every player and shares no one. Use the same pair in both challenges' videos. The reading's second card sets one twin side by side, but it chooses the twin itself from the player's answers. Do not use the "pushy" against "takes charge" pair: since 24 October a player who goes by the numbers picks both hidden people there, so it shows nothing. A separate video from the Learning one, framed for workplaces, with the same pair.

SETTINGS Upload to YouTube or Vimeo as **public**, then paste the link. Solve's question sheet asks for the privacy setting to be public, so do not use unlisted.

11 What specific problem are you solving?

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The specific problem within the Challenge; its scale where we work and globally; how many people it affects; what causes it.

MATERIAL

- **The gap.** Solve's own Challenge page: "women remain 24% less likely than men to participate in the labor force." In India, 41.7% of women aged 15 and over are in the labour force, against 78.8% of men (Periodic Labour Force Survey 2023-24, MoSPI).
- **Part of it is decided inside workplaces.** Who is hired, given the shift or the route, sent on the course, promoted, believed. When science faculty rated identical applications from "John" and "Jennifer", John was judged more competent and hireable and offered a higher salary (Moss-Racusin and colleagues, 2012).
- **The bias is common.** UNDP's 2023 Gender Social Norms Index finds nearly 9 in 10 people worldwide hold at least one bias against women. *Found in secondary reports: confirm in the UNDP report before citing.*
- **Training rarely reaches the decision.** Gender training at work is often a one-off session counted by attendance, so no one can see whether decisions get fairer. One-off diversity training has weak and short-lived effects (Dobbin and Kalev, 2016). *Team: add an example from a company you know, if you have one.*

DRAFT

12 What is your solution?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

What it is, what it does, how it works and what technology it uses, in simple terms. About the solution, not the problem. A link to a video of a product demo, if relevant.

MATERIAL

- **A fairness puzzle game on the phone** set in five illustrated Indian workplaces and homes: a railway junction, trucks on a ghat road, a travelling magic show, a cricket ground and a family home. The five chapters are set between 1971 and 1999, told as a grandmother's memories. What runs today is the First take: one sitting of five chapters and 40 decisions, ending in a private reading. *Planned, not built:* three daily puzzles, at Easy, Medium and Hard.
- **Each decision is a real kind of workplace or household call:** who drives the ghat section tonight, who carries the cash to the next town, who captains the first XI, who gets the 2 seats on the new-engine course, who holds the keys to the cash box. It shows 3 to 5 people with their records.
- **Two of them have identical records**, one woman and one man. One detail on their cards differs, such as "her family worries about her night runs". Later, a twin decision puts that detail on the man, with a different equal pair. The identical pair is there in all 40 decisions.
- **The reading comes from the pairs.** The man both times is a lean towards men; the woman both times is a lean towards women; following the detail both times is no lean. In some twins the detail really matters, such as who holds the licence. Today the reading counts picks; how they become one figure is still being worked out.
- **What each player gets today:** a private reading of five cards: how often they picked the woman or the man when the two were equal, one twin side by side, the part of life that leaned most, a tip, and a last card saying it is a first reading from one sitting. Hard-topic twins are not used for the twin and part-of-life cards. *Planned, not built:* daily practice on new cases, and leaderboards that reward fair play both ways.
- **What runs today,** live at https://tel-retake.vercel.app: the First take, about 20 minutes by the title cards' estimate; the app does not time it. In Hinglish, Hindi (a draft) and English. It installs on a phone, works offline, asks for a birth date first and shuts out under-18s, and keeps everything on the phone. *An idea for the workplace version, not yet designed:* an anonymous summary for employers showing which kinds of decision lean. The product plan lists only a workplace kit, outside the app, for later; the employer summary is an idea built on it.

DRAFT

13 Who does your solution serve, and in what ways will the solution impact their lives?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The people whose lives we aim to improve, how they are underserved now, and how the solution meets their needs.

MATERIAL

- **The people deciding:** managers, supervisors, recruiters and HR staff in Indian organisations, including transport, logistics, retail, manufacturing and small businesses. Their everyday calls decide who gets work and who moves up.
- **The people decided about:** women at entry level and on the frontline, whose shifts, routes, training and promotions depend on a supervisor's call. Men too: the reading counts a lean either way.
- **How they are underserved:** training rarely touches the decision itself and is rarely measured, so a fair worker can be passed over without anyone noticing a pattern.
- **What we aim to change:** decision-makers notice when a word such as "her family worries" is doing the work; once a workplace version exists, an organisation sees where its decisions lean and can add clear criteria there.
- **Private, built in today:** one entry on the player's phone keeps the answers, the language, the sound switch, the place in the take and an adult's birth date (for someone under 18, only the day the game opens and whether "Wrong date?" was used), and nothing is sent anywhere: the app makes no network calls of its own, has no analytics, and records no times. Delete all, under Privacy in the "?" sheet, wipes it at once. Adults only: the birth date comes first, and under 18 the game stays shut (the date is self-declared).
- **For the workplace version (an idea, not yet designed):** each person's reading would stay private and an employer would see only anonymous totals, so no one is judged or penalised by their reading.
- **Not yet:** help lines in the app. Three national help lines for the hard-topic chapters were checked against official sources on 27 October: Tele-MANAS 14416 for bullying at work; the national emergency number 112 for being followed, harassment and violence at home; NALSA's legal aid line 15100 for parents who separate and a dowry demand. They are not yet in the app, which still plays those chapters without them. Today Retake is made for adults on their own phones; only the team has played it, and no workplace uses it.

DRAFT

14 Would you like to save these answers to a Solution Profile?

READY

ANSWER Save as a New Solution Profile

WHY If the Learning profile is already saved, do not reuse it here as it is: the problem, solution and who-it-serves answers are written differently for workplaces. Save this one separately.

SECTION 3 · YOUR ELIGIBILITY

Can Solve review us? Yes, at Prototype stage.

15 Is technology a core part of your solution?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Yes, tech is core to our solution.

WHY The training and the reading are the app: the paired decisions, the shuffling and the reading cannot run without it.

16 Does your solution address an economic opportunity or financial inclusion problem?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Yes

WHY Biased decisions about who is hired, assigned and promoted limit women's access to work and to advancement. That is economic opportunity.

17 What is your solution's stage of development?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Prototype

WHY Solve: "An initial working version of a solution that may be in the process of getting initial feedback or testing with users (i.e. running a pilot)... (Often 0 users/direct beneficiaries)". The app is now live and working, but no one outside the team has used it, so it is still a Prototype. Concept would not be reviewed at all, and Pilot needs a launch in at least one community. Solve warns that "exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection."

18 Please share details about why you selected the stage above.

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

What we have built and tested so far. Only what is done, not plans.

BUILT

- The First take, live at https://tel-retake.vercel.app: one sitting of five chapters with 40 workplace and household decisions, 13 painted cutscenes and a private reading of five cards at the end. About 20 minutes by the title cards' estimate; the app does not time it.
- 20 twin pairs. In all 40 decisions the hidden two are one woman and one man with exactly the same numbers; in every twin the swayed detail switches sides, with different hidden people.
- Eight kinds of decision playable today: pick one, believe, captain, spend checks, rank, pick a team, a batting order and sharing out chores. Four more are designed for the planned dailies.
- Five illustrated worlds: 58 painted faces in the First take (345 in the art library), 46 painted cutscene panels and 15 scene paintings.
- Three languages: Hinglish, Hindi and English. The Hindi is a draft, not yet read by a native speaker.
- An installable app that works offline and reopens on the same decision. Adults only: the birth date comes first and under-18s are shut out. Privacy and Delete all in the "?" sheet; nothing leaves the phone.
- Layouts from phones to desktops, and a design system the app's styles come from.

TESTED

- The last full run of the automated checks, 25 October, on the code now live: all 181 passed. That is 46 checks of the code that run without opening the app: 4 of privacy, 4 of the built app, and 38 of the older daily content and its scoring code, kept for the planned dailies and not used by the live app. Then 106 checks that play the app in a browser, including the whole First take in all three languages at phone and laptop size (54), the first visit (10) and Delete all (14); 23 install, offline and update checks; 4 accessibility checks; and 2 checks that each of the 40 decisions has the same markup structure as the signed-off demo.
- Accessibility: an automated accessibility check against the international web standard (WCAG 2.2, levels A and AA) on every kind of screen, at phone and laptop size, in Hinglish and Hindi: no violations. A manual screen-reader check is still to do.
- An internal audit of the build on 25 October: 73 findings, each re-checked by a second reviewer. Most of the app faults it found were fixed the same day, with 25 new checks; four are still open, one of them (the batting order never shows the note its twin depends on) also among the three faults in how the reading counts. *Team: say who ran it before citing it.*
- Counted on 27 October: every hidden pair in the live set matches on every number. The standing checker still reads the 22 October draft, so it does not yet guard the live set.
- Played by the owner on their own phone. The automated checks run in a desktop browser at phone and laptop sizes, not on a real phone.

SAY PLAINLY

No workplace and no one outside the team has used it yet. Three faults in how the reading counts, found by the audit, are still open. That is why this is a Prototype.

DRAFT

SECTION 4 · SOLUTION & TEAM DETAILS

Reach, team and contacts. Mostly facts only the team has.

19 How many beneficiaries or customers does your solution currently serve?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER

0

WHY

Solve: "The option you select here will not change your chances of being selected", and it asks us to "Be honest", since "exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection." Count only people reached by Retake itself, not by our other programmes. The only players so far are the team, and the app collects nothing, so there is no usage count to quote.

20 Does your solution have a website, app, or social media handle?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

ANSWER

Yes. List The Equal Lens website and the app link, https://tel-retake.vercel.app, and only that link for Retake (decided 27 October).

WHY

There are two Retake links, both open to anyone who has them and hidden from search engines:

- **The app,** https://tel-retake.vercel.app. It asks for a birth date before anything else and keeps under-18s out.
- **The team demo,** https://tel-retake.vercel.app/demo/. The older demo: no birth date, and it plays all 12 hard-topic decisions (bullying, being followed, harassment backstage, violence at home, parents who separate, a dowry demand).

Never list /demo/. Neither link has help lines yet: the three national lines checked against official sources on 27 October (question 13) are not yet in the app or the demo. If a judge opens /demo/, they play those chapters with no age check and no help line.

BEFORE SHARING

Changed in the app's code on 27 October, and live with the owner's next deploy: the page title, link-preview title and install card now say "Retake: a fairness puzzle" (no "daily"); the link-preview text says "Made-up people. Everything you play stays on your phone."; and Privacy's "Kept nowhere" line says only "How long you take." Open the link before submitting and check the title and Privacy show the new words.

LINKS

21 **Which dimension of the Challenge does your solution most closely address?**

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER

Create pathways to quality employment and economic opportunity, particularly for young people and workers excluded from formal labor markets as AI and other technologies reshape entry-level work.

WHY

Fairer decisions about who is hired, assigned and promoted open the way into work and up through it for women. The other two listed dimensions are financial health and resilience, and housing, which do not fit; the form also offers "Other". Do not claim an AI angle we do not have.

22 How are you and your team well-positioned to deliver this solution?

REQUIRED · 300 WORDS · WRITE · FACTS NEEDED

SOLVE ASKS

Not credentials. They want the experience, relationships, data and knowledge to deliver, with **specific examples of how we have engaged the people we serve**, how many, and how that input shaped the solution.

MATERIAL

- The Equal Lens's work on gender norms through play, and the facilitation experience behind it. *Team: years, sessions, places.*
- Any conversations with employers, HR teams or worker groups, and what they told us about how training is done and measured today. *Team: names and numbers where they can be shared.*
- How their input shaped Retake, only if the team can name real conversations. *If there were none, drop this point and say instead:* the decisions are written to mirror everyday calls, such as who takes the night run, which route, who gets the course seats and who holds the keys.
- The team's background in design, research and facilitation. *Team: fill in.*
- The content is written for India: Indian workplaces, a cast of 58 painted faces from across the country and its faiths, three languages (the Hindi still a draft).

DRAFT

23 In which countries do you currently operate?

READY

ANSWER

India

24 Which, if any, additional countries will you be operating in within the next year?

FACTS NEEDED

HOW TO CHOOSE

Leave it empty unless a partner abroad is actually lined up.

25 How many people work on your solution team?

REQUIRED · 100 WORDS · FACTS NEEDED

GIVE

Separate numbers for full-time staff, part-time staff, and contractors or other workers. Count volunteers under "other" and say they are volunteers. Same numbers as the Learning application.

ANSWER

26 How long have you been working on your solution?

REQUIRED · 100 WORDS · FACTS NEEDED

GIVE

The years The Equal Lens has worked on gender norms, and Retake itself since October 2026 (the first build record is 19 October). *Team: the founding year, and any earlier design work on Retake, honestly dated. The two applications are separate, so each describes our work in its own words: this one says "gender norms". Dates and numbers stay the same in both.*

ANSWER

27 Why are you applying to Solve?

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The financial, technical, legal, cultural or market barriers Solve can help with, and how. Solve warns: "If your only goal in applying to Solve is to raise funds, Solve is not the right program for you!"

MATERIAL

- **Technical: validation.** Test whether a change in the game predicts fairer real decisions, against a partner company's own hiring and promotion records with consent. We need research partners for this.
- **Market: access to employers.** Introductions to companies and HR networks for a first workplace pilot, and help with pricing and selling to organisations.
- **Legal: privacy and ethics at work.** Today the app keeps everything on the player's phone and sends nothing, and Delete all wipes it. A workplace version would need more: consent, anonymous totals for employers, and no one judged by their reading, all within India's data protection rules. We have had no legal advice on those rules yet, and the app has no contact for data questions yet.
- **Cultural: content at scale.** Decisions drawn from more sectors and more Indian languages for frontline workforces, and a native speaker's read of the Hindi, which is still a draft.

DRAFT

28 Who is the Team Lead for your solution?

REQUIRED · FACTS NEEDED

WHO

The head of the organisation, responsible for Retake's direction. Name only, and the same person as in the Learning application. This person pitches to judges over Zoom in February if we are Finalists, and travels to Cambridge, MA for Orientation on 14 to 15 April 2027 and to New York in September if we are selected.

NAME

29 Contacts for Solve only (not seen by judges)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

FILL

Team lead's email (required), team lead's phone with country code (required), and a backup contact's name, email and phone. If we are Finalists Solve writes to the team lead in early February, with a short deadline to confirm, so give an inbox someone watches. A backup contact makes sure the message is not missed.

30 Questions about the team lead and our history (Solve only)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

THE QUESTIONS

- Is the Team Lead a resident of the United States? **No**, unless that changes.
- What is the Team Lead's gender? Is the Team Lead transgender? *The team lead answers, or chooses "prefer not to answer".* Solve asks for reporting only; judges never see it.
- Has anyone from our organisation been selected as a Solver before? **No**, unless someone has. Only if yes, a further question asks what makes this solution different from the earlier one.
- Is the solution part of another entrepreneurship network (incubator, accelerator, fellowship)? *Team: check.*
- Did you take the MITx course "Business and Impact Planning for Social Enterprises"? Answer truthfully; it does not affect selection.
- Did you hear about Solve through a network or mailing list? *Team: check.*

Why it is new, why it will work, and how it pays for itself.

31 What makes your solution innovative?

300 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

How it approaches the problem in a new or much improved way; how it differs from others; how it could change the field.

MATERIAL

- **It works on the decision, not on attitudes.** Gender training at work is often a one-off session, and one-off diversity training has weak and short-lived effects (Dobbin and Kalev, 2016). Changing people's scores on implicit-bias tests does not reliably change what they do (Forscher and colleagues, 2019).
- **It reads decisions, not answers to a questionnaire,** using the logic of the identical-CV studies, inside a game people choose to play. Whether the reading is a valid measure is still to be tested.
- **It reads a lean either way,** towards men or towards women, and is built to separate being swayed by a word from being swayed by gender (not yet validated). No one is accused, and favouring women counts as much as favouring men. Players never see the words bias, test or gender.
- **Private by design:** the game and its reading run on the phone, and nothing the player does is sent anywhere.
- **Planned: a daily habit, not a workshop.** Three daily puzzles, at Easy, Medium and Hard, with leaderboards scored both ways. *Not built yet: what runs today is the one-sitting First take.*
- **Made for India,** including frontline workers: set in Indian workplaces and homes, with Indian names and languages, from Hinglish to Hindi, on a phone, offline. The app's code is kept small for weak phones and connections: about 110 KB compressed, under a 130 KB budget; to work offline it saves about 3.8 MB, mostly pictures and fonts, on the first visit (not yet tried on a basic phone or a weak connection).
- **For the field, once a workplace version exists:** a way for organisations to see whether their gender training changes decisions, which attendance counts cannot show. *The employer summary this needs is an idea, not yet designed.*

DRAFT

32 Describe in simple terms how and why you expect your solution to have an impact on the problem.

300 WORDS WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

Our theory of change: how activities lead to outputs and to short- and long-term outcomes, with evidence for each link (research, interviews, our own data).

MATERIAL

- **Activities (in a workplace version, an idea not yet designed, using the planned dailies):** managers and employees play the daily puzzles; each gets a private reading and a "look again" at a pair they treated differently; the organisation would see anonymous totals (an idea, not yet designed). *Today:* the one-sitting First take ends in a private reading that sets one twin side by side.
- **Outputs:** a private reading per person (built: the First take's five cards, including the part of life that leaned most); a map of which kinds of decision lean across an organisation, such as promotions as against shift assignments (an idea for the workplace version, not yet designed).
- **Short-term outcomes we expect:** decision-makers notice when a word or detail is doing the work; HR would add clear criteria where the organisation leans (once a workplace version exists).
- **Long-term outcomes we expect, still to be shown:** fairer hiring, assignment and promotion; more women entering work and moving up.
- **Evidence for the links:** identical-application studies show bias acts in decisions (Moss-Racusin 2012); clear criteria and structured decisions reduce bias (Bohnet, *What Works*, 2016); a habit-breaking programme of noticing and practice reduced implicit race bias on a test for weeks (Devine and colleagues, 2012); whether this carries into decisions is what our pilot would test.
- **The honest gap:** whether a change inside the game carries into real decisions is what the pilot will measure, against a partner's own records.

DRAFT

33 Describe your solution's tech stack and how you know that it works.

300 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The technology, and proof that it works. For new technology, a paper or other public evidence.

MATERIAL

- **The app:** a web app that installs on a phone and works offline (a Progressive Web App), built with Vite, React and TypeScript; React is its only runtime library. Hosted on Vercel at https://tel-retake.vercel.app. The puzzles are data, so new content needs no new code. Three languages switch on every screen.
- **Nothing leaves the phone:** the app makes no network calls of its own and has no analytics or outside code, and its security policy lets it connect only to its own address. One entry on the phone keeps the answers, the language, the sound switch, the place in the take and an adult's birth date (for someone under 18, only the day the game opens and whether "Wrong date?" was used), with no times; Delete all removes it. Offline, 145 files (3.8 MB) are kept on the phone, and the code is about 110 KB compressed.
- **The reading:** every decision has a twin built to the same rules, and the reading is plain arithmetic on the phone. Counted on 27 October, every hidden pair in the live set matches on every number. The checker that refuses a set where the pair's numbers differ, where a person repeats, or where a hard fact is said of a name that marks a community still reads the 22 October draft, so adapting it to the live set is owed, and the live set breaks one of its rules today: 4 twins put the same other person in both halves (Mohan, Ramesh, Rani and Vikram). The content export already refuses a set where a note's length could give away the pair, or a Hindi line or a picture is missing.
- **The art:** illustrations are made with an open image model (FLUX.2 klein) run on our own computer, then checked and edited (crops, colour, small marks painted out). Players never interact with AI, and AI plays no part in the reading.
- **How we know it works:** the live app (the video shows it). The last full run of the automated checks, 25 October, on the code now live, passed all 181: 46 static checks (4 of privacy, 4 of the built app, and 38 of the older daily content and its scoring code, kept for the planned dailies and not used by the live app), 106 play-through checks in a desktop browser at phone and laptop size (the whole First take in all three languages, the first visit, Back, Delete all, focus), 23 install, offline and update checks, 4 accessibility checks (axe-core, WCAG 2.2 A and AA, no violations) and 2 checks that each of the 40 decisions has the same markup structure as the signed-off demo. An internal audit on 25 October: most of the app faults it found were fixed the same day, with 25 new checks; four are still open, one of them (the batting order never shows the note its twin depends on) also among the three faults in how the reading counts.
- **Not yet built or proven:** that the reading is a valid measure; an automated check that the reading's counts are right (there is none yet); any employer summary (an idea, not yet designed); a manual screen-reader check; automated tests on a real phone; fixes for three known faults in how the reading counts; and a fix for notes such as "..., Mohan says", which sit on 23 of the 83 other cards and never on the equal pair's, so a careful player can spot the pair. Say so, and that validation comes first in the funded work.

DRAFT

34 Please select the technologies currently used in your solution.

READY

ANSWER

Software and Mobile Applications · Behavioral Technology · Generative AI

WHY

The illustrations are made with an open image model run on our own computer, then checked and edited (question 33 says so); players never interact with AI, and AI plays no part in the reading. Answer the same way as in the Learning application.

35 What is your business model?

300 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

How we create value for the people we serve: key customers and beneficiaries, what we give them, how, and why they want it.

MATERIAL

- **Customers:** companies and organisations that already spend time on gender training. India's POSH Act requires employers to hold regular awareness programmes, so time is already set aside for this. *Check the Act's wording before citing.*
- **What they would get (planned):** gender-fair decision practice their people come back to (the dailies, not built yet), and an anonymous picture of where their decisions lean (an idea, not yet designed), which a one-off session cannot give.
- **Beneficiaries:** the women and men whose hiring, shifts and promotions depend on those decisions.
- **Access (an idea, for a workplace version still to be designed):** a subscription per employee for companies; free for NGOs and small employers through CSR sponsorship. The product plan lists only a workplace kit, outside the app, for later; the subscription is an idea built on it.
- **Mission link:** income from workplaces would keep the game free for adults on their own phones, as the First take is today, and could later fund a separate student version, still to be designed. *Never describe a student version as existing: none exists, and the product's rules today say adults only. A student version is designed only after the reading passes validation with adults, and no tool that is not validated is ever tried on anyone under 18.*

DRAFT

36 Do you primarily provide products or services directly to individuals, to other organizations, or to the government?

TEAM LEAD

ANSWER

Organizations (B2B)

WHY

In a workplace version (an idea, not yet designed), employers would be the customers and their people the players. None is a customer yet; today the app is free for adults on their own phones, and only the team has played it. B2B is the planned model; what runs today serves individuals (B2C).

37 What is your plan for becoming financially sustainable, and what evidence can you provide that this plan has been successful?

300 WORDS | WRITE | FACTS NEEDED

SOLVE ASKS

How money comes in (grants, donations, sales, government contracts, investment) and evidence it has worked so far: grants received, revenue, funder names and amounts where they can be shared.

MATERIAL

- **Company subscriptions** as the main income, after a first paid pilot. *An idea, not yet designed: the product plan lists only a workplace kit, outside the app, for later, and the subscription is built on it.*
- **CSR funds** could sponsor free use by NGOs and small employers. Companies above set size or profit thresholds must spend at least 2% of their average net profit of the last three years on CSR (Companies Act 2013, s.135). *Check the Act's wording before citing.*
- **Grants** for the validation research.
- **Evidence to date.** *Team: grants received, any company conversations or letters of interest, with names and amounts if they can be shared. If there are none yet, say what is in progress, honestly.*

DRAFT

SECTION 6 · SUBMIT

Last checks. Then the team lead submits.

Check	Done
Every required question answered, in English, within its limit	
The five claims under "Before you start" hold in every answer: no users, no paying customers, reading not validated, no claim about real hiring or promotion, nothing planned described as built	
Only the app link (https://tel-retake.vercel.app) listed, not /demo/	
The live app shows "Retake: a fairness puzzle" and Privacy's new line (the owner's deploy)	
Every shared fact matches the Learning application	
The UNDP figure, the POSH Act wording and the Companies Act CSR rule confirmed in their originals, or removed	
Our own numbers (team, sessions, funding, company conversations) checked by the person who knows them	
The video is public, and the link opens when signed out	
Submit Solution clicked by Monday 2 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India); the final deadline is Friday 6 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India)	

SOURCES · CHECKED 22 OCTOBER 2026; SOLVE'S PAGES AND RETAKE'S FIGURES RE-CHECKED 27 OCTOBER 2026

1. **MIT Solve, 2027 Global Economic Prosperity Challenge** (solve.mit.edu/challenges/2027-global-economic-prosperity-challenge), re-checked 27 October 2026: the questions, dimensions, stage definitions, deadline, the FAQ on entering more than one challenge, and "women remain 24% less likely than men to participate in the labor force" (Solve gives no source for this figure).
2. **MIT Solve, 2027 Global Challenges: Application Questions** (PDF linked from the challenge page: 5593819.fs1.hubspotusercontent-na1.net/hubfs/5593819/2027%20Global%20Challenges_%20Application%20Questions.pdf), checked 27 October 2026: the stage question's wording, the rule that Concept is not reviewed, the 2 November line, the Orientation dates, the short confirmation window, pitching in English, the video's 2-minute limit and public setting, the 200-word limit of question 27, the options for question 19, the AI processing consent's wording and the order of the agreements.
3. **Retake's own figures**, counted on 27 October 2026 from the live app's content and code, and from the full run of its automated checks on 25 October 2026.
4. **MoSPI, Periodic Labour Force Survey annual report, July 2023 to June 2024** (press note, September 2024): labour force participation at 15 and over, women 41.7%, men 78.8%.
5. **UNDP, 2023 Gender Social Norms Index:** nearly 9 in 10 people hold at least one bias against women. Found in secondary summaries; confirm in the UNDP report before citing.
6. **Moss-Racusin and colleagues (2012),** "Science faculty's subtle gender biases favor male students", PNAS.
7. **Dobbin and Kalev (2016),** "Why Diversity Programs Fail", Harvard Business Review.
8. **Forscher and colleagues (2019),** "A meta-analysis of procedures to change implicit measures", Journal of Personality and Social Psychology.
9. **Bohnet (2016),** *What Works: Gender Equality by Design*, Harvard University Press.
10. **Devine and colleagues (2012),** "Long-term reduction in implicit race bias: a prejudice habit-breaking intervention", Journal of Experimental Social Psychology.
11. **The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013** (the POSH Act): employers' duty to hold awareness programmes at regular intervals. Check the wording in the Act before citing.
12. **The Companies Act, 2013, section 135** (corporate social responsibility): companies above set net-worth, turnover or profit thresholds spend at least 2% of their average net profit of the three preceding years. Check the wording in the Act before citing.

Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.